

Robert J. Carroll

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Current appointment

2019– *Assistant Professor of Political Science*, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Previous appointments

2015–2019 *Assistant Professor of Political Science*, Florida State University

2014–2015 *Visiting Fellow*, Kroc Institute for International Peace Studies, University of Notre Dame

Education

2015 PhD in Political Science, University of Rochester
2014 MA in Political Science, University of Rochester
2009 MA in Political Science, Michigan State University
2007 BA in Government, University of Louisiana at Monroe

Publications

- 2026 **Robert J. Carroll**, David M. Konisky, and Christopher Reenock. "Policy Devolution & Cooperation Dilemmas." Forthcoming in *Journal of Theoretical Politics*.
- 2024 Peter Bils, **Robert J. Carroll**, & Lawrence S. Rothenberg. "Strategic Avoidance & Rule-making Procedures." *Journal of Theoretical Politics* **36**(2): 156–185.
[DOI: 10.1177/09516298241237209](https://doi.org/10.1177/09516298241237209)
- 2021 **Robert J. Carroll** & Amy Pond. "Costly Signaling in Autocracy." *International Interactions* **47**(4): 612–632.
[DOI: 10.1080/03050629.2021.1898956](https://doi.org/10.1080/03050629.2021.1898956)
- 2019 **Robert J. Carroll** & Brenton Kenkel. "Prediction, Proxies, & Power." *American Journal of Political Science* **63**(3): 577–593.
[DOI: 10.1111/ajps.12442](https://doi.org/10.1111/ajps.12442)

Publications (cont.)

- 2016 **Robert J. Carroll**, David M. Primo, & Brian Kelleher Richter. "Using Item Response Theory to Improve Measurement in Strategic Management Research: An Application to Corporate Social Responsibility." *Strategic Management Journal* 37(1): 66–85.
[doi: 10.1002/smj.2463](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.2463)

Work under review

Fighting in the Shadow of Intervention: A Learned-Proxy Analysis
The Causal Content of Game-Theoretic Models
Preferring Unified Theories
Sunspot Volatility and the Price of Peace
Making Peace on the Cheap
A State Is Its Relations: The Yoneda Lemma and Relational Identity in IR

Book manuscripts under review

The Shape of Possible States
Policy Spaces as Organizational Schemes: A Semantic Theory of Electoral Competition

Other work in progress

A Theory of Force (book manuscript)
Borders, Spillovers, & the Watershed Lattice (with David Konisky & Chris Reenock)
War and Peace in the Marketplace
Careers and Conflict in Revolutionary France

Grants, honors, & awards

- 2023–2024 James H. Kuklinski Award for Excellence in Graduate Mentoring, Department of Political Science, UIUC
2021–2022 Clarence A. Berdahl Award for Excellence in Undergraduate Teaching, ΠΣΑ, UIUC
2020–2021 Peter Nardulli Award for Research, UIUC
2020–2025 List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Their Students, UIUC
2020–2021 Dina Zinnes Graduate Teaching Award, Department of Political Science, UIUC
2020–2021 Impact Award, College of Liberal Arts & Sciences, UIUC
2015 First Year Assistant Professor Award, FSU
2014 Top 5 Paper, Annual Meeting of the Strategic Management Society

Courses taught

University of Illinois

Strategic International Relations
State Formation
Strategic Models
International Relations Seminar (G)
International Political Economy (G)
Game Theory I (G)
Game Theory II (G)
Mechanism Design (G)
Readings in the Political Economy of Authoritarian Regimes (G)
Readings in the Political Economy of International Environmental Institutions (G)

Florida State University

Civil Wars and Political Violence
Special Topics in War and Peace
Understanding Political Science Research
Politics and the Theory of Games
Theories of Conflict (G)
Probability and Statistics (G)
Game Theory (G)
Readings in the Political Economy of Human Capital (G)

Advising

Graduate students

Xiaoli Guo (FSU, defended April 2018)
Matt Hauenstein (FSU, defended July 2018)
Phil Henrickson (FSU, defended November 2018)
Jordan Holsinger (FSU, defended June 2021)
Hyun Joo Cho (UIUC, defended May 2022)
Miles Williams (UIUC, defended June 2022)
Tolgahan Dilgin (UIUC, defended July 2023)
Jinwon Lee (UIUC, defended May 2025)
Do Young Gong (UIUC, defended March 2026)
Sydney Gann (FSU)
Faon Crystal (UIUC)
Seungmi Kim (UIUC)
Ji Soo Yoo (UIUC)
Paul Un (UIUC)

Undergraduate theses supervised

2025–2026	Sam Crutcher
2025–2026	Savannah Smith
2023–2024	Ethan Cooper
2023–2024	Chenyu Jiang
2022–2023	Sotis Gouriots
2020–2021	Chris Buckley
2017–2018	Zachary Shuman

Service

Departmental committee work

2023–2024	Graduate Affairs Committee, UIUC Department of Political Science
2022–2023	Advisory Committee, UIUC Department of Political Science
2020–2021	IR Search Committee, UIUC Department of Political Science

Refereeing

American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, Comparative Political Studies, Conflict Management and Peace Science, International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Conflict Resolution, Journal of Global Security Studies, Journal of Peace Research, Journal of Politics, and Political Analysis

Last updated: April 20, 2026.